

Send Me Some

Are you lost? Don't worry. You can nowadays SMS your way out of almost anything. Using a combination of Ericsson's Mobile Positioning System (MPS), Ericsson's SMS Gateway and AutoDesk Inc's Location-Logic, text-messaging can now pinpoint a user's location.

The first location-based text-messaging services will lay the foundation for more data-rich services. Using these services, mobile operators will be able to offer advanced versions of SMS such as EMS (Extended Message Service) and MMS (Multimedia Messaging Service).

These messaging services will allow the system to attach images, such as maps, to the reply message without upgrading their entire network infrastructure. So hopefully you'll be carrying your mobile with you the next time you are lost.

Thumbelina

Here's good news for those born without thumbs or have lost them in accidents. Students in Singapore have developed a battery-free artificial gadget made of aluminum that acts



as a substitute for a missing thumb.

The device, called 'Mimic', is small, lightweight and straps onto the back of the hand and wraps round the index finger to hold a moveable metal thumb in place. This metal thumb mimics the forefinger and moves whenever the forefinger moves. Two small pulleys and a fine steel cable keep the forefinger's movements in sync with the metal thumb. This device even allows a person to write and pick up small objects.

The prototype will be available at just 100 Singapore dollars. But it isn't an off-the shelf product. Each piece will have to be custom made to fit the wearer's hand.

Bluetooth going gold

Despite a slow start and months of stagnancy, Bluetooth is finally poised to take off. The wireless networking technology that is designed to replace cables that connect devices is beginning to reach critical mass. A growing number of products already on the market and those set for release next year are bringing back the hope Bluetooth once had. Market researcher Dataquest predicts that demand for Bluetooth this year will result in the shipment of about 4 million chipsets. The company predicts shipments will rise to 36 million in 2002 and 186 million in 2003.



heroes

Windows XP

- Microsoft finally delivers a stable, user-friendly OS
- Castle Wolfenstein
- The 3D game is back in a new avatar and takes the market by storm
- VIA
- Court case against Intel won. Expect DDR-based motherboard chipsets for Pentium 4



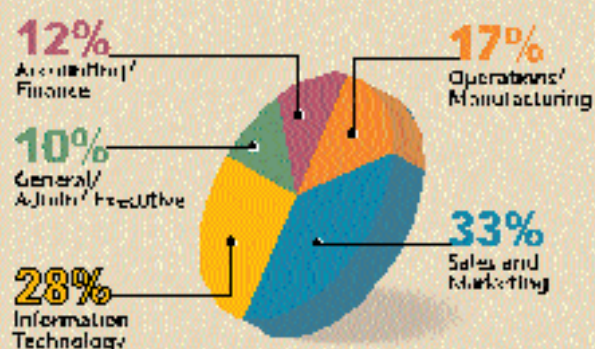
zeroes

iPAQ

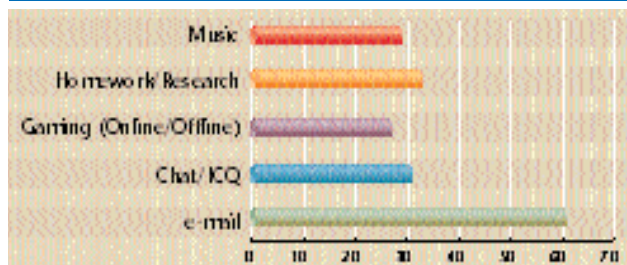
- Sales of iPAQ shrivelled from 450,000 to 185,000 as users waited for Pocket PC 2002
- Domain Name Lottery
- .biz staggers as NueLevel, the company responsible for introducing the Internet address, fights a lawsuit for playing illegal lottery for contested names
- Excite
- Excite UK shuts down the UK operations after funding falls short

statattack

Internet-related jobs: Not just in IT



Kids online: What are they doing?



INFOGRAPHICS: Solomon Lewis

Shr(i)ek!

The Shrek DVD features a first-ever 'U-Dub-It' feature that allows users to dub their own voice in place of any of the characters and 12 additional DVD-ROM games. Shrek's ReVoice Studio uses technology that lets the viewer become the actor. The program enables viewers to select from 12 of the film's most popular scenes and record the lines of the characters. It then syncs up their voice with the character's mouth. As you read the on-screen script into a microphone the program automatically synchronises your voice with the lip movements of the character you have chosen to play. It's a bit like Karaoke, only better.

Source: www.internetindicators.com

Source: www.researchbottle.com

■ Sun pushes UltraSparcIII to over 1 GHz ■ ATI A3 Athlon XP chipset revealed ■ Windows XP causes Intel mobile chips to overheat ■ Palm to replace buggy devices